SELF ASSESSMENT · 2025/26 TAX YEAR

Not everyone has to file a tax return.

If your only income is wages or a pension, the tax usually comes off through PAYE — straight out of your pay — and no return is normally due. The question starts the moment money arrives from somewhere else.

WHEN YOU MUST FILE

£1,000

You were self-employed as a sole trader and took more than £1,000 — what came in, not what you kept. Or you were a partner in a business. Or you had Capital Gains Tax to pay.

> Untaxed income may bring you in too: rent, tips, savings interest, dividends, money from abroad. GOV.UK says may, not must.

WHO DOES NOT FILE

PAYE

If your only income is wages or a pension, the tax comes straight out of your pay and no return is normally due. But one exception catches people out.

> The exception: the Child Benefit tax charge, where one of you has adjusted net income over £60,000 and it is not taken from wages. And a notice to file from HMRC is answered whatever you owe.

SELF ASSESSMENT · 2025/26 TAX YEAR

Not sure whether you have to file?

Tell us what came in during the 2025/26 tax year and we will say what to check. No obligation.

0330 133 1886

General information. For your own situation, speak to an accountant.